

MICHAEL J. MACDONALD

Senior Systems Administrator | DevOps & Cloud Infrastructure Automation

Salem, MA +1 (617) 606-4830 macado@gmail.com

CORE SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure as Code

- Ansible / Ansible Automation Platform (AAP)
- Puppet / Foreman
- Salt (SaltStack)
- Red Hat Satellite
- Terraform (vSphere, AWS, F5 BIG-IP LTM)
- AWS (Landing Zone Accelerator, IAM, VPC)

Containers & Orchestration

- Red Hat OpenShift (Kubernetes)
- Docker / Podman

Virtualization & Systems

- VMware ESXi / vSphere
- Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL)
- Rocky Linux / CentOS
- Linux / Unix Variants
- Cisco UCS, HP ProLiant, Dell PowerEdge

CI/CD & Version Control

- GitHub Actions
- Jenkins
- Git / GitLab / GitHub / SVN

Monitoring & Logging

- Splunk / Elasticsearch / Syslog-ng
- Nagios / Icinga
- CrowdStrike Falcon (endpoint sensor)

Networking & Storage

- F5 BIG-IP LTM / GTM
- NetApp OnTap
- EMC Networker

Identity & Access Management

- Active Directory / LDAP
- Microsoft Entra ID (SSO, SCIM provisioning)
- Grouper (provisioning to Entra ID & on-prem AD)
- Shibboleth (SAML: IdP & SP)
- Duo Security (MFA)
- CyberArk Conjur (secrets management)

Web & Application

- Apache / Nginx

Languages & Scripting

- Python, YAML, Bash, Perl
- HTML / CSS / XML
- Working knowledge: PowerShell, C, C++

CERTIFICATIONS

Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)

Cert #140-192-733

Microsoft Certified Systems Administrator (MCSA)

Cert #5619998

Microsoft Certified Professional MCP, MCDST, MCTS

EDUCATION

Salem State College

Salem, MA
Coursework completed: 56 credits, 2003–2006
Cumulative GPA: 3.508

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Systems Administrator with 15+ years of enterprise infrastructure experience, evolving toward a DevOps-focused practice built on infrastructure as code, automation, and configuration management. Author Terraform modules to provision infrastructure across vSphere, AWS, and F5 BIG-IP; leading a Puppet-to-Ansible Automation Platform (AAP) migration managing roughly 700 RHEL virtual machines; contributor to AWS Landing Zone Accelerator deployment in a multi-account environment. Proven track record supporting mission-critical, large-scale virtualized infrastructure (1,000+ servers) for a major research university.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Systems Administrator

Dec 2013 - Present

Tufts University, Tufts Technology Services — Somerville, MA

- Administer enterprise-wide virtualized infrastructure spanning 1,000+ servers on Cisco UCS hardware, NetApp FC SAN storage, and VMware vSphere hypervisors, supporting services for the entire university.
- Author and maintain Terraform configurations to provision and manage infrastructure as code across vSphere, AWS, and F5 BIG-IP LTM, standardizing deployments across on-premises and cloud environments.
- Lead the ongoing migration from Puppet to Ansible Automation Platform (AAP), refactoring legacy Puppet code into Ansible playbooks to manage a fleet of approximately 700 RHEL virtual machines.
- Deploy and support Red Hat OpenShift (Kubernetes) on VMware vSphere to run containerized workloads.
- Contributed to deployment and support of AWS Landing Zone Accelerator in a multi-account AWS environment, including IAM configuration and VPC networking.
- Administer identity and access management across Microsoft Entra ID and on-premises Active Directory, including SSO application integrations and SCIM-based provisioning (GitHub, AWS); use Grouper for group-based provisioning into Entra ID and on-prem AD, and operate Shibboleth as both Identity Provider (IdP) and Service Provider (SP) for SAML federated authentication.
- Perform full-lifecycle RHEL system administration, including installation, patching and package management, compiling open-source software, troubleshooting, monitoring, user account management, and backups.
- Support DevOps-style CI/CD for a load-balanced, Nginx-based Drupal hosting environment, using Jenkins and Git for automated build and deployment pipelines.

Senior Operations & Systems Specialist

Oct 2011 - Dec 2013

Tufts University, Tufts Technology Services — Somerville, MA

- Delivered enterprise support, systems administration, and infrastructure design and planning for centralized services used university-wide.
- Managed Group Policy Objects (GPOs), OS image configuration and deployment, and application packaging.
- Served as technical liaison for campus-wide IT projects in partnership with business and academic units and schools.

Information Technology Analyst

Mar 2010 - Oct 2011

Tufts University, Financial Information Systems — Somerville, MA

- Supported PeopleSoft applications, internal LAMP-stack web applications, and network share (ACL) management for financial reporting systems.
- Led a hardware refresh cycle and Windows 7 / Office 2010 deployment project; provided systems administration, application packaging and deployment, and tier 3 desktop support for the Finance Division.

Desktop Support Technician

Aug 2008 - Mar 2010

Tufts University, Information Technology Services — Somerville, MA

- Provided desktop and network support for the Fletcher School of Law and Diplomacy, including tier 2/3 support for VIP clients under an on-call rotation.

Systems Administrator

Sep 2007 - Aug 2008

Pepper Hamilton LLP, Multi-practice Law Firm — Boston, MA

- Delivered on-site network support, systems administration, and desktop support; administered Active Directory user accounts, Exchange mailboxes, Group Policy, login scripts, and network share ACLs.
- Managed daily backups and tape rotation across all servers using Backup Exec and CommVault; provided tier 3 application and network support for attorneys and staff in a 24/7 on-call rotation.